Introduction
Setting Up Your Study Plan
Start Studying
Taking Simulation Exams
Customizing Your Own Exams
Using My Review (important!)

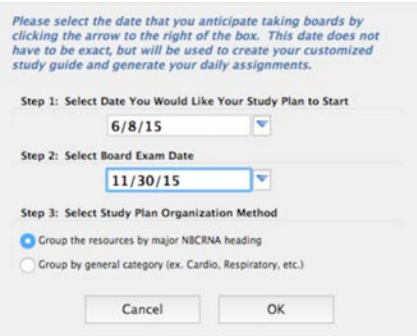
INTRODUCTION

PACES contains an entirely new approach to preparing for boards. It is the culmination of interviews with hundreds of students over the past ten+ years and is the result of what they used, what they felt was most successful, and most importantly, what they wished was available to help them study. The plan below utilizes the PACES Study Plan Creator and the IntelliStudy® algorithm to maximize your studying efficiency by prioritizing the information that you need to study.

Although many students start cramming for boards the day after they graduate, I recommend preparing for boards as soon as your anesthesia program begins. Having a keen understanding of what is expected of you when you take the NBCRNA board exam will be of great benefit as you are studying during your anesthesia program. The material contained within the software can also help you prepare more adequately for exams during your nurse anesthesia program.

SETTING UP YOUR STUDY PLAN

Set up your Study Plan in the PACES software by selecting Create New Study Plan from the Options menu at the top of the screen. You will be prompted to select the date you take boards. This does not have to be exact –a rough approximate will suffice. Most students take boards about a month after they graduate.



Next, select how you would like to group the study plan. You can choose NBCRNA headings or general categories. If you choose NBCRNA headings then you would study cardiac anatomy and physiology in one section, but it may be several weeks before you reach cardiac surgery because it is in a different NBCRNA heading. Selecting general category will group all cardiac topics in the 'Cardiac' heading, all neuro topics under 'Neuro', etc.

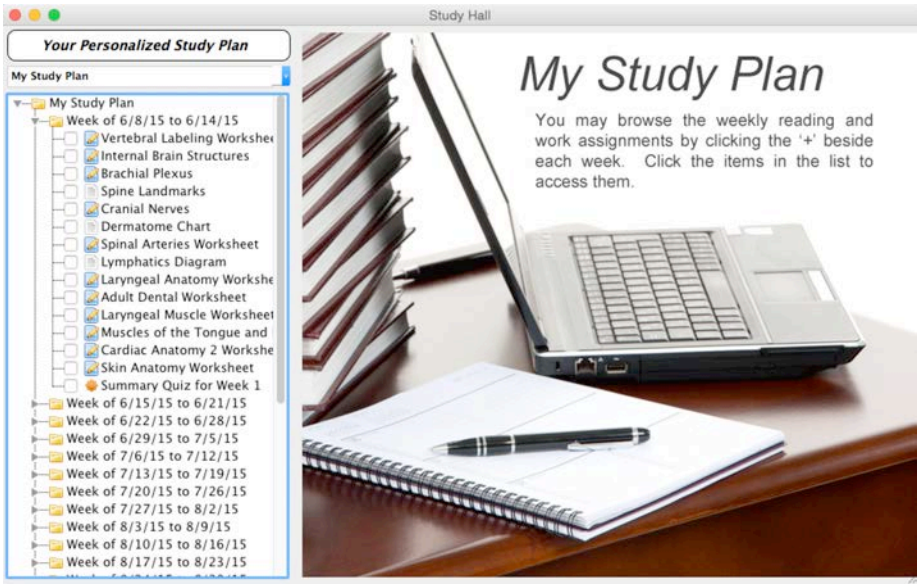
Please be patient while the program calculates your study plan. Depending upon the speed of your computer, it could take a minute or more to finish creating the plan.

All of the simulation exam questions are derived from the study materials in your study plan. Should you need to create a new study plan, just select Create New Study Plan from the Options menu at the top of the page.

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START STUDYING

If you click the Study Plan button on the PACES main screen, you will be able to view your entire study plan. Each week is organized in a separate folder. Clicking an item in the list on the left side of the screen will open the document.



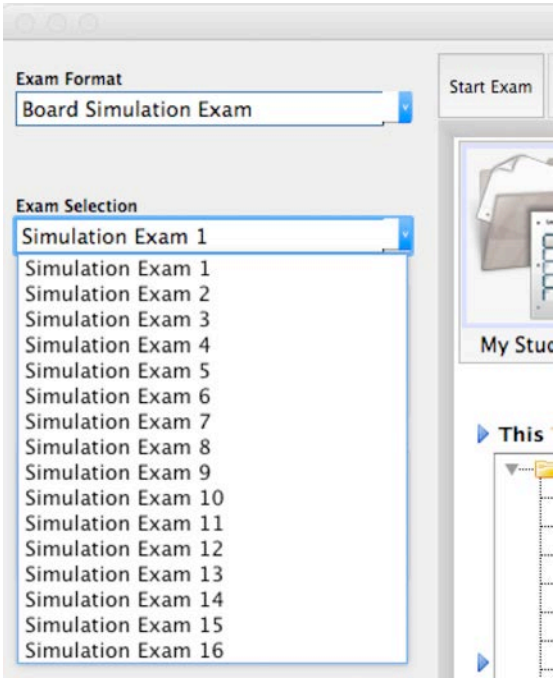
At the end of each week, there is a link for a summary quiz. The questions for the summary quizzes are derived from the topics assigned during that week.

The questions come from the bank of general questions and will include questions from Simulation Exams 1-10. Questions from simulation exams 11 and higher do not appear in the weekly exam quizzes.

I recommend practicing with Simulation Exams 1-10 as you are working through your study plan. That way you can save simulation exams 11 and higher as more difficult assessments to coordinate with My Review (explained later) as you get closer to boards .

TAKING SIMULATION EXAMS

You can access the pre-built simulation exams by selecting it from the Exam Selection menu. Each exam is 100 questions long, contains all of the NBCRNA question types, and is designed according to the NBCRNA student handbook.



You can opt to take the exam with a standard three-hour time limit or with no limit set. You can also choose to take exams in Practice Mode or Board Simulation Mode.

Practice Mode will provide you with the correct answer, rationale, and reference for each question as well as a link to the document that contains the study information pertaining to the question. It will also provide you with your current score.

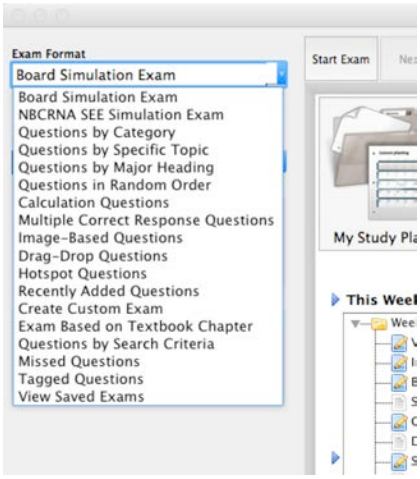
Board Simulation mode replicates the actual NBCRNA exam. It will not indicate your current score, progress, correct answers or rationales until the end of the exam.

I recommend taking exams in Board Simulation mode because it allows you to get used to 'not knowing how you are doing ' on the exam. Many students experience a great deal of anxiety on test day. When they finally commit to a guess on the exam and move to the next question, they are often still mulling over their last guess rather than focusing on the question at hand.

If you are prone to exam anxiety, I recommend taking exams in Board Simulation mode.

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CUSTOMIZING YOUR OWN EXAMS



Taking pre-designed simulation exams is not the only way to access questions from PACES. In fact, there are 18 different ways to access questions. You can choose to take exams based on search criteria, specific categories, major NBCRNA headings, specific question types (ex. drag and drop versus multiple correct response), and so on. You can even create exams based on a specific Textbook and Chapter, which is handy if you have an upcoming exam on, say Chapters 10-14 of Nagelhout's Nurse Anesthesia book, for example.

PACES also keeps up with all of the questions you miss. You can take just those questions by selecting Missed Questions from the Exam Format menu. Once you answer a question correctly, it is removed from the list.

You can also tag questions for review later if you are in Practice Mode and reviewing the by selecting Tagged Questions from the Exam Format menu.

When you click Quit Exam, you are asked if you would like to save it to review later. You can access those exams from the View Saved Exams option in the Exam Format menu. Questions in Random Order cannot be saved, however, because it would re-randomize the questions when you restarted the exam.

USING MY REVIEW

My Review is the most powerful component of the entire program and enables you to study using the most individualized and efficient method possible.

Any time you are answering exam questions in the simulator, the IntelliStudy® engine is running in the background analyzing your performance.

It continually records your responses and calculates the odds that you will miss the next questions in any and all of the NBCRNA categories.

It then compares that data to the likelihood that each particular topic will appear on the actual exam.



The IntelliStudy® engine uses a set of mathematical formulas to try and answer the question, "Based on your individual performance, which topic, if you knew it better right now, would increase your board score the most?"

For example, you may score better in airway management than you do in valvular diseases, but the algorithm might determine that you are still better off focusing more on airway management because you are far more likely to encounter questions on that topic. Once it makes all of the calculations, it ranks the study materials from top to bottom based on which topics would be most likely to increase your board exam score the most.

So, study the materials in My Review from top to bottom, placing more focus on the topics closest to the top.

Once you have studied that material as best you can, take another exam. When you are done, open My Review again. It will recalculate everything again. As you get better at some topics, they will filter down towards the bottom of the list as the topics that would benefit you most percolate to the top.

The whole point is to save you from studying material that you already know and/or doesn't have a statistically significant relevance to the test. That is different for every student, though, and My Review creates its recommendations based on your individual performance.

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